

KEY CONCEPT

PSYCHOLOGICAL OPERATIONS

The United States also used psychological persuasion, known as PSYOPS, to win over the populace—and to threaten the NVA and Viet Cong. General Westmoreland claimed that PSYOPS and civic action were at the heart of counterinsurgency. A key tactic of PSYOPS was to drop leaflets from aircraft. Typically, these would urge people to reject the Viet Cong and support the South Vietnamese government.



» AFTER

In 1971, the Combined Action Program was disbanded. The Phoenix Program became the main counterinsurgency tool.

SHIFTING RESPONSIBILITY

Nixon's policy of **Vietnamization**, which handed primary responsibility for combat operations over to the South Vietnamese Army (ARVN), led to the decline of the CAP program.

UNPOPULAR PROGRAM

In the final years of the war in Vietnam, counterinsurgency operations consisted mainly of those under the auspices of the **Phoenix Program**, a countrywide effort of American special forces units, CIA operatives, and the South Vietnamese military to "neutralize" suspected Viet Cong insurgents through incarceration or assassination. The fact that innocent civilians were caught in the dragnets of Phoenix caused **public support** for the Saigon government and the US presence in South Vietnam to wane.